

"We do have very good open source professionals in India. We work with open source technologies and use a number of open source products as part of our solutions and technology offerings to our customers. In terms of getting enough open source technology professionals, I think India is an extremely good place for that. I think it is one of the reasons India team works on such programs, as availability of talent is one of the key considerations in deciding what the company wants to do in a particular facility."

to reducing our overall development costs, not only for us, but for our customers too. And at the same time, it offers them the ability to handle mission-critical systems and applications, with the value addition coming from Unisys.

Q Is this value addition not possible with proprietary technologies?

It is possible, but the amount of investments you have to make to build something from scratch, as against taking something that is close to what you need and adapting it, are pretty high. The skillsets that you need to operate in the proprietary space are unique and not something that you can typically find among university students. You need to train resources to work on those technologies. But that also requires investment and time. Open source technologies have a clear advantage in such situations as they give you a clear headstart from the development perspective, and the development process gets more efficient automatically.

Q Do you reach out to open source communities if you get bogged down by any technologically complicated situation?

We certainly use the resources available in the open source space. But I can honestly say that I cannot recall a situation where our guys have been at a loss for a solution when faced with a problem. We have been in the business for many years now, and I can confidently say that we can find a solution to any issue, within the campus, on the basis of our experience and expertise. But that doesn't take away from the fact that we are constantly looking at developments in the market place and in the community to continue innovating with new technologies.

Q How many engineers do you have in the Indian facility?

In the Indian engineering and technology group, we have about 400 people. On the technology solutions side, we have got close to 800-900 people. The technology group basically focuses on engineering products, while the solutions group uses the technologies from Unisys and others to develop solutions, which we apply to the different verticals.

Q What are the skills you look for when you recruit engineering talent at Unisys?

We basically look for engineering graduates, post graduates and doctorates who have got a good knowledge of systems, the ability to work on systems' engineering and product engineering activities, etc. We look for people with a good research and development mindset, who can deep dive into technologies, who can think at a systems level and who can follow product engineering concepts.

Q How important are certifications for a company like Unisys?

Certifications always add value to the profile of a candidate. We do look at that aspect when we hire and candidates do get in if they have the relevant certification. 

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